

Job Posting: 469484 - Position: Ascendance Fellow

Co-op Work Term Posted:	2026 - Fall
App Deadline	05/19/2026 09:00 AM
Application Method:	WaterlooWorks
Posting Goes Live:	05/09/2026 09:00 AM
Job Posting Status:	Approved

Company Information

Organization	Ascendance Foundry Inc
Division	Divisional Office

Job Posting Information

Work Term	2026 - Fall
Job Type	Co-op Main
Job Title	Ascendance Fellow
Number of Job Openings	15
Level	Junior Intermediate
Region	ON - Toronto
Job - Address Line One	325 Front Street West
Job - City	Toronto
Job - Province/State	Ontario
Job - Postal/Zip Code	M5V 2Y1
Job - Country	Canada
Employment Location Arrangement	Hybrid

Additional Employment Arrangement Location Information

This is a hybrid work environment. All Fellows are expected to show up in person in downtown Toronto (Union Station area) for the Bootcamp week, weekly Expert workshops and bi-weekly Group Demo Days. Given that learning is generally more effective in person, we recommend Fellows being in the office at least 3 days per week. Some Fellows may have additional on-site requirements for clients in the Toronto area. Some projects may involve occasional (optional) travel to the US for meetings.

Work Term Duration 8 month consecutive work term preferred

Special Work Term Start/End Date Considerations

4-month and 8-month placements are available.

Special Job Requirements

Students are responsible for ensuring they are eligible for an 8-month work term before applying for one. Please discuss your work/study sequence flexibility with your academic advisor as soon as possible.

Job Summary

Ascendance Foundry is built on two beliefs: 1) apprenticeship belongs at the centre of education, and 2) winning with AI demands the fastest workforce retraining in history. We help companies across many industries learn how to leverage modern AI tools to transform their businesses through a unique consulting model that incorporates structured learning, opening up new revenue opportunities while gaining operational efficiency. Ascendance Fellows are recruited from amongst the top students who have

completed 2 years of University or less, and are paired with clients on focused transformation projects, while both receiving structured mentorship from seasoned founders, executives, and technical leaders.

Program Overview:

The Ascendance Fellowship is a fully paid, elite apprenticeship where you dive into real-world projects from day one. Fellows train with AI tools, deliver impact inside top companies, and learn from industry leaders. With expert mentorship, an ambitious peer network, and no tuition, it's a launchpad to an accelerated, high-impact career.

Week 1: Intensive AI-Bootcamp: Intensive training in AI tools and development workflows. Hands-on projects with LLMs, automation, and data pipelines.

Weeks 2-16+ (Client Project Placement). Apply AI-native practices to deliver high-impact results, embedded in a real-world role at a client company.

Weekly Expert Workshops. Learn directly from industry leaders and technical mentors from our Expert Network, which includes senior technical leaders, AI experts and business leaders from across several industries.

Weekly Group Office Hours: Get together weekly with peers and mentors to help debug each other's day-to-day work.

On-Demand Mentorship & Customized Training. Ongoing 1:1 mentorship throughout the term. Personalized support on tools, techniques, and project challenges. Customized training to match the scope of the project.

Types of projects available:

The types of projects available vary from term to term, depending on the needs of our clients, but generally fall into three broad categories: a) Strategy & Management Consulting, b) Analytics & Data Science, c) Custom Application Development. While not all projects available to Fellows will be finalized and contracted by Match date, here is a representative sample of projects we are working on now. In addition to the types of projects below, there will be at least one opening focused internally on improving our educational programming and expanding our reach with industry.

Project Examples:

1. Building an automation strategy for a large global legal process outsourcing firm: This project focuses on transforming a legal process outsourcing firm, into a Business Process Automation (BPA) firm through strategic AI adoption, through a combination of off-the-shelf software solutions and custom middleware. Fellows will play a key role in developing and implementing AI-driven solutions to enhance efficiency, expand service offerings, and build a comprehensive AI strategy for presentation to prospective buyers. This is a unique opportunity to contribute to a forward-thinking initiative at the intersection of legal technology and cutting-edge AI.

2. Building accounting and project management automations for a mid-sized construction company: This project is similar in scope to Project 1, except for a mid-sized Canadian construction company. We are helping the company develop and build out their automation strategy from the ground floor, focusing on their accounting and project management functions, enabling them to price and forecast projects more accurately, while delivering more efficiently.

3. Building and managing Ascendance Foundry's proprietary trading fund: We have launched a proprietary trading fund that our Fellows help us manage, which tests and executes several trading strategies (med-long-term bets on secular trends, event-based strategies, etc).

4. Building a sales and coaching agent for Ascendance Foundry: One of the consequences of mass AI adoption is that many more brick and mortar businesses will be able to design and build their own hyper-customized automations without having to hire large consulting firms or build large internal engineering teams. However, doing so requires mastering a whole new operating language and building small strike teams of SMEs and Forward-Deployed engineers with a different combination of skillsets. We are building an agent that helps teach prospective clients how to get started on this journey. This will be used to drive new sales as well as to guide our existing Fellow-client teams.

Job Responsibilities

Responsibilities will vary somewhat with the type of project placement, but generally fall into three buckets:

1. Strategy & Management Consulting - support market analyses, research on specific companies, and conduct financial analysis to inform client recommendations. They will also assist in preparing decks, proposals, and business cases while collaborating with the team to evaluate strategic options and organize client meetings and workshops.

2. Analytics & Data Science - assist with data collection, cleaning, and analysis, while supporting the development of models and visualizations to extract insights. They will collaborate with the team to document findings, test methodologies, and apply statistical and machine learning techniques to real-world datasets.
3. Custom application development - support coding, testing, and debugging of application features while assisting with research, documentation, and deployment activities. They will work closely with the development team in an agile environment, gaining hands-on experience with modern tools, best practices, and real-world software engineering workflows.

Required Skills

We don't expect our Fellows to come in with a long list of skills coming into the program (building foundational skills and a network is the whole point of the program), but we expect you to show up everyday with an attitude that lives up to our brand ideals:

"Driven, Agile, Resourceful AF. AI-First."

• ***Some basic coding experience would be helpful for most projects.***

Compensation and Benefits

Compensation:

All Ascendance Fellows receive a non-negotiable stipend of **\$15,000 per 4-month term**. All Fellows receive access to all the educational programming listed in the Job Summary free of charge.

Application Information

Application Delivery WaterlooWorks

Additional Application Information

Applicants who have relevant portfolios (e.g. public Github repositories, etc.) are welcome to share them with their resumes (not a requirement).